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Great Apps from the Android Market Place

- **Twidroid:** This is the best Twitter and identi.ca application available on the Android Market Place. It doesn't just let you update your status messages and reply to others, but also allows you to visit their profiles, follow and unfollow them, upload images to the image service of your choice, and even customise notifications for new tweets, replies and direct messages.

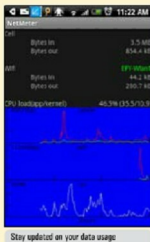


- **iMusic:** No doubt, this is the most popular application on the Market Place! iMusic allows you to get connected to the Gnutella file sharing network and actually download videos, images and songs right onto your Android phone!

- **PicMe:** While Android does not have an inherent screenshot-taking app, the developers have come out with a wonderful application that allows you to take screenshots of the mobile, remotely. All the phone needs is to be connected to a wireless network and the screenshot can be taken by any computer logged onto the same network. Since HTC Hero does not have any physical keyboard, there are no keyboard shortcuts and this seems to be the best way of taking a screenshot.



- **Netmeter:** Not many service providers in India offer unlimited data transfer plans, these days. So, Netmeter is a great app to keep an eye on the amount of data you have already transferred on your network. It gives separate stats for mobile network traffic and wireless traffic. What's more, it will also point out the CPU load utilised by each of the processes running on your phone, so that you can identify the ones gorging on the bandwidth and take appropriate action.



- **Bluetooth File Transfer:** While HTC Hero does not allow transfer of media files using Bluetooth, this app will help you do so. However, it uses a different port (port 29) to communicate using the Bluetooth protocol.

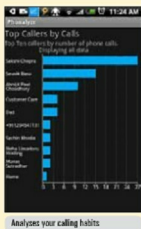
- **Qik:** This application has been very 'qik' to pick up steam and become one of the leading services in live video blogging. All you need to do is install the app on your mobile, fire it up, and keep shooting videos of events. The videos will automatically get streamed, live, via Qik's network, using your mobile service provider's bandwidth. While you will need 3G for the streaming to be seamless, it works very smoothly on a broadband wireless network.



- **ConnectBot:** This application will make every Linux enthusiast roar in unison, "I am the power of the Universe!" ConnectBot actually lets you connect to other machines in your network, using ftp or ssh, and then presents you with a console screen for you to play around. Awesome app, we say!

- **StumbleVideo:** While the default YouTube application is more than capable of streaming videos, StumbleVideo adds the spice of StumbleUpon to it. Yes, you can actually stumble videos on your Android phone, thumbs-up a video or just keep discovering new ones.

- **Phonalyzer:** More than being useful, this is one of the most amusing mobile phone apps I have ever witnessed. It simply sits in the background and keeps accumulating statistics about your phone usage. Then, it presents you with the information, in the form of interesting graphs, like 'Top Callers by Minutes', 'Top Callers by Calls', 'Missed vs Regular Calls', 'Call Length Distribution', etc.



- **Compass:** While this is primarily a fun app, it has the potential to turn into something very useful if you are one of those who often get off the beaten track. What helps the phone navigate are the extra-sensitive accelerometers housed within it.